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There are a few different distributions of Linux, like Ubuntu, Mint, Fedora, RedHat, Debian, Google's Android, Chrome OS, and Chromium OS which are popular among users.

The Linux operating system was originated in 1991, as a project of "Linus Torvalds" from a university student of Finland. He posted information about his project on a news group for computer students and programmers. He received support and assistance from a large pool of volunteers who succeeded in creating a complete and functional Operating System. Linux is similar to the UNIX operating system.

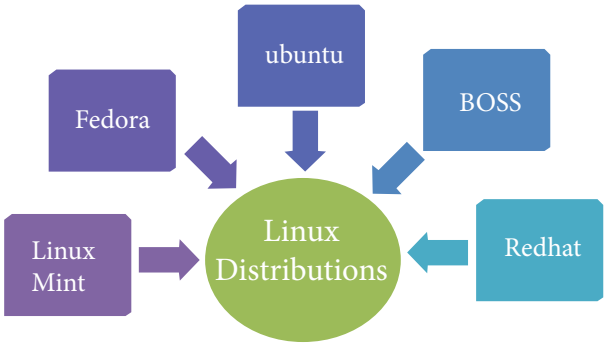


*Figure: 4.8 Linux Distributions*

*Figure: 4.9 Microsoft WindowsFolder Screen*

DO YOU KNOW?

Unix and the C programming language were developed by AT&T and distributed to government and academic institutions, which led to both being ported to a wider variety of machine families than any other operating system.

### 4.5.3 Microsoft Windows

Microsoft Windows is a family of proprietary operating systems designed by Microsoft Corporation and primarily targeted to Intel and AMD architecture based computers.

DO YOU KNOW?

ReactOS is a Windows-alternative open source operating system, which is being developed on the principles of Windows - without using any of Microsoft's code.